

Quiz 1 – Detailed Solutions

Problem 1

Let $(Y_1, Y_2, Y_3)^\top \sim N_3((\mu_1, \mu_2, \mu_3)^\top, \Sigma)$ where $\Sigma = (1 - \rho)I_3 + \rho\mathbf{1}\mathbf{1}^\top$.

Part (a)

Define $\mathcal{Z} = (Y_1 - Y_2, Y_2 - Y_3, Y_1 + Y_2 + Y_3)^\top$. Find the distribution of $\mathcal{Z}$.

Theory: For a linear transformation of a multivariate normal vector, say $Z = AY$, we have

$$Z \sim N_p(A\mu, A\Sigma A^\top).$$

We will compute the mean vector and covariance matrix explicitly.

Solution: Let

$$A = \begin{pmatrix} 1 & -1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & -1 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mu = (\mu_1, \mu_2, \mu_3)^\top.$$

Then $\mathcal{Z} = AY$, so

$$E[\mathcal{Z}] = A\mu = \begin{pmatrix} \mu_1 - \mu_2 \\ \mu_2 - \mu_3 \\ \mu_1 + \mu_2 + \mu_3 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Now compute the covariance:

$$\text{Var}(\mathcal{Z}) = A\Sigma A^\top.$$

Since $\Sigma = (1 - \rho)I_3 + \rho\mathbf{1}\mathbf{1}^\top$, we have

$$A\Sigma A^\top = (1 - \rho)AA^\top + \rho(A\mathbf{1})(A\mathbf{1})^\top.$$

First,

$$A\mathbf{1} = \begin{pmatrix} 1 - 1 + 0 \\ 0 + 1 - 1 \\ 1 + 1 + 1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ 3 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Next,

$$AA^\top = \begin{pmatrix} 2 & -1 & 0 \\ -1 & 2 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 3 \end{pmatrix}.$$

Therefore,

$$\text{Var}(\mathcal{Z}) = (1 - \rho) \begin{pmatrix} 2 & -1 & 0 \\ -1 & 2 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 3 \end{pmatrix} + \rho \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 9 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 2(1 - \rho) & -(1 - \rho) & 0 \\ -(1 - \rho) & 2(1 - \rho) & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 3(1 - \rho) + 9\rho \end{pmatrix}.$$

Simplify the (3,3) entry: $3(1 - \rho) + 9\rho = 3 + 6\rho$.

Thus

$$\mathcal{Z} \sim N_3 \left(\begin{pmatrix} \mu_1 - \mu_2 \\ \mu_2 - \mu_3 \\ \mu_1 + \mu_2 + \mu_3 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 2(1 - \rho) & -(1 - \rho) & 0 \\ -(1 - \rho) & 2(1 - \rho) & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 3 + 6\rho \end{pmatrix} \right).$$

Part (b)

Hence, or otherwise, find the conditional distribution of $(Y_1 - Y_2, Y_2 - Y_3)^\top$ given $\bar{Y}$.

Theory: If (Z_1, Z_2, Z_3) are jointly normal, then the conditional distribution of (Z_1, Z_2) given $Z_3 = z_3$ is normal with mean

$$\mu_{12} + \Sigma_{12}\Sigma_{22}^{-1}(z_3 - \mu_3)$$

and covariance

$$\Sigma_{11} - \Sigma_{12}\Sigma_{22}^{-1}\Sigma_{21},$$

where the covariance matrix of (Z_1, Z_2, Z_3) is partitioned as

$$\begin{pmatrix} \Sigma_{11} & \Sigma_{12} \\ \Sigma_{21} & \Sigma_{22} \end{pmatrix}.$$

Solution: From part (a), let $Z_1 = Y_1 - Y_2$, $Z_2 = Y_2 - Y_3$, $Z_3 = Y_1 + Y_2 + Y_3 = 3\bar{Y}$. We see that the covariance between (Z_1, Z_2) and Z_3 is zero, i.e. $\Sigma_{12} = 0$ and $\Sigma_{21} = 0$. Hence they are independent (jointly normal and uncorrelated). Therefore,

$$(Z_1, Z_2) \perp Z_3,$$

so the conditional distribution of (Z_1, Z_2) given Z_3 (or given $\bar{Y}$) is the same as its unconditional distribution.

Thus

$$(Y_1 - Y_2, Y_2 - Y_3)^\top \mid \bar{Y} \sim N_2 \left(\begin{pmatrix} \mu_1 - \mu_2 \\ \mu_2 - \mu_3 \end{pmatrix}, \begin{pmatrix} 2(1 - \rho) & -(1 - \rho) \\ -(1 - \rho) & 2(1 - \rho) \end{pmatrix} \right).$$

Part (c)

Define $\underline{W} = \underline{Y} + \underline{q}$ where $\underline{q} \in \mathbb{R}^3$. Find the conditional distribution of $\underline{W}$ given $\bar{Y}$.

Theory: For a multivariate normal vector Y with mean μ and covariance Σ , the conditional distribution of Y given $\bar{Y} = \frac{1}{3}\mathbf{1}^\top Y$ is again normal. Its mean and variance can be derived using the joint normality of $(Y, \bar{Y})$.

Solution: We first find the conditional distribution of Y given $\bar{Y}$. Let $\bar{Y} = \frac{1}{3}(Y_1 + Y_2 + Y_3)$. Then

$$E[\bar{Y}] = \frac{\mu_1 + \mu_2 + \mu_3}{3} =: \bar{\mu}.$$

Compute the variance of $\bar{Y}$:

$$\text{Var}(\bar{Y}) = \frac{1}{9}\mathbf{1}^\top \Sigma \mathbf{1}.$$

Now $\Sigma \mathbf{1} = (1 - \rho)\mathbf{1} + \rho\mathbf{1}(\mathbf{1}^\top \mathbf{1}) = (1 - \rho)\mathbf{1} + 3\rho\mathbf{1} = (1 + 2\rho)\mathbf{1}$, so $\mathbf{1}^\top \Sigma \mathbf{1} = \mathbf{1}^\top (1 + 2\rho)\mathbf{1} = 3(1 + 2\rho)$. Hence

$$\text{Var}(\bar{Y}) = \frac{3(1 + 2\rho)}{9} = \frac{1 + 2\rho}{3}.$$

The covariance between Y and $\bar{Y}$ is

$$\text{Cov}(Y, \bar{Y}) = \frac{1}{3}\Sigma \mathbf{1} = \frac{1 + 2\rho}{3}\mathbf{1}.$$

Thus, using the conditional normal formula,

$$E[Y \mid \bar{Y}] = \mu + \frac{\text{Cov}(Y, \bar{Y})}{\text{Var}(\bar{Y})}(\bar{Y} - \bar{\mu}) = \mu + \frac{\frac{1+2\rho}{3}\mathbf{1}}{\frac{1+2\rho}{3}}(\bar{Y} - \bar{\mu}) = \mu + \mathbf{1}(\bar{Y} - \bar{\mu}).$$

The conditional covariance is

$$\text{Var}(Y \mid \bar{Y}) = \Sigma - \frac{\text{Cov}(Y, \bar{Y}) \text{Cov}(Y, \bar{Y})^\top}{\text{Var}(\bar{Y})}.$$

Since $\text{Cov}(Y, \bar{Y}) = \frac{1+2\rho}{3}\mathbf{1}$, we have

$$\frac{\text{Cov}(Y, \bar{Y}) \text{Cov}(Y, \bar{Y})^\top}{\text{Var}(\bar{Y})} = \frac{\left(\frac{1+2\rho}{3}\right)^2 \mathbf{1}\mathbf{1}^\top}{\frac{1+2\rho}{3}} = \frac{1 + 2\rho}{3} \mathbf{1}\mathbf{1}^\top.$$

Therefore

$$\text{Var}(Y \mid \bar{Y}) = (1 - \rho)I_3 + \rho\mathbf{1}\mathbf{1}^\top - \frac{1 + 2\rho}{3}\mathbf{1}\mathbf{1}^\top = (1 - \rho)I_3 + \left(\rho - \frac{1 + 2\rho}{3}\right) \mathbf{1}\mathbf{1}^\top.$$

Now

$$\rho - \frac{1 + 2\rho}{3} = \frac{3\rho - 1 - 2\rho}{3} = \frac{\rho - 1}{3} = -\frac{1 - \rho}{3}.$$

Hence

$$\text{Var}(Y \mid \bar{Y}) = (1 - \rho)I_3 - \frac{1 - \rho}{3}\mathbf{1}\mathbf{1}^\top = (1 - \rho) \left(I_3 - \frac{1}{3}\mathbf{1}\mathbf{1}^\top \right).$$

So

$$Y \mid \bar{Y} \sim N_3 \left(\mu + \mathbf{1}(\bar{Y} - \bar{\mu}), (1 - \rho) \left(I_3 - \frac{1}{3}\mathbf{1}\mathbf{1}^\top \right) \right).$$

Since $W = Y + q$ with q fixed, we simply add q to the conditional mean:

$$\boxed{W \mid \bar{Y} \sim N_3 \left(\mu + q + \mathbf{1}(\bar{Y} - \bar{\mu}), (1 - \rho) \left(I_3 - \frac{1}{3}\mathbf{1}\mathbf{1}^\top \right) \right)}.$$

Note that $\bar{\mu} = (\mu_1 + \mu_2 + \mu_3)/3$ and $\bar{Y}$ is the observed average.

Problem 2

Let $X_i \stackrel{\text{ind}}{\sim} \text{Gamma}(\alpha_i, 1)$ for $i = 1, \dots, p$. Define

$$Y_p = X_1 + \dots + X_p, \quad Y_i = X_i/Y_p \quad \text{for } i = 1, \dots, p-1.$$

Part (a)

Using the transformation technique, find the joint pdf of $Y = [Y_1, \dots, Y_p]^\top$.

Theory: The transformation from X to Y is one-to-one. The joint density of Y is obtained by multiplying the joint density of X by the absolute value of the Jacobian determinant.

Solution: The joint density of $X_1, \dots, X_p$ is

$$f_X(x_1, \dots, x_p) = \prod_{i=1}^p \frac{1}{\Gamma(\alpha_i)} x_i^{\alpha_i-1} e^{-x_i}, \quad x_i > 0.$$

Define the transformation:

$$y_i = \frac{x_i}{s} \quad (i = 1, \dots, p-1), \quad y_p = s = \sum_{i=1}^p x_i.$$

The inverse transformation is

$$x_i = y_i y_p \quad (i = 1, \dots, p-1), \quad x_p = y_p \left(1 - \sum_{i=1}^{p-1} y_i \right).$$

The Jacobian matrix of the inverse transformation is

$$J = \frac{\partial(x_1, \dots, x_p)}{\partial(y_1, \dots, y_{p-1}, y_p)} = \begin{pmatrix} y_p I_{p-1} & \mathbf{y} \\ -y_p \mathbf{1}^\top & 1 - \sum_{i=1}^{p-1} y_i \end{pmatrix},$$

where $\mathbf{y} = (y_1, \dots, y_{p-1})^\top$ and $\mathbf{1}$ is a vector of ones.

Using the block determinant formula

$$\det \begin{pmatrix} A & B \\ C & D \end{pmatrix} = \det(A) \det(D - CA^{-1}B),$$

with $A = y_p I_{p-1}$, $B = \mathbf{y}$, $C = -y_p \mathbf{1}^\top$, $D = 1 - \sum y_i$, we get

$$D - CA^{-1}B = 1 - \sum_{i=1}^{p-1} y_i + \mathbf{1}^\top \mathbf{y} = 1.$$

Thus $\det(J) = \det(y_p I_{p-1}) \cdot 1 = y_p^{p-1}$. Since $y_p > 0$, the absolute value is y_p^{p-1} .

Now substitute into the density:

$$\begin{aligned} f_Y(y_1, \dots, y_{p-1}, y_p) &= f_X(x_1, \dots, x_p) |\det J| \\ &= \prod_{i=1}^p \frac{1}{\Gamma(\alpha_i)} \left(\prod_{i=1}^{p-1} (y_i y_p)^{\alpha_i-1} \right) \left(y_p (1 - \sum y_i) \right)^{\alpha_p-1} e^{-\sum x_i} \cdot y_p^{p-1}. \end{aligned}$$

But $\sum x_i = \sum_{i=1}^{p-1} y_i y_p + y_p(1 - \sum y_i) = y_p$. Therefore $e^{-\sum x_i} = e^{-y_p}$.
Now collect powers of y_p :

$$\prod_{i=1}^{p-1} y_p^{\alpha_i-1} \cdot y_p^{\alpha_p-1} \cdot y_p^{p-1} = y_p^{\sum_{i=1}^{p-1} (\alpha_i-1) + (\alpha_p-1) + (p-1)} = y_p^{(\sum_{i=1}^p \alpha_i) - 1}.$$

The y_i part becomes

$$\prod_{i=1}^{p-1} y_i^{\alpha_i-1} \cdot \left(1 - \sum_{i=1}^{p-1} y_i\right)^{\alpha_p-1}.$$

Thus the joint density is

$$f_{Y_1, \dots, Y_{p-1}, Y_p}(y_1, \dots, y_{p-1}, y_p) = \frac{1}{\prod_{i=1}^p \Gamma(\alpha_i)} \left(\prod_{i=1}^{p-1} y_i^{\alpha_i-1} \right) \left(1 - \sum_{i=1}^{p-1} y_i \right)^{\alpha_p-1} y_p^{\sum_{i=1}^p \alpha_i - 1} e^{-y_p},$$

for $y_i > 0$ ($i = 1, \dots, p-1$), $\sum_{i=1}^{p-1} y_i < 1$, and $y_p > 0$.

Part (b)

Hence, find the joint pdf of $[Y_1, \dots, Y_{p-1}]^\top$ and the marginal distribution of Y_p .

Theory: To obtain the marginal of a subset, integrate the joint density over the other variables. The integral over the simplex of a Dirichlet kernel yields the Dirichlet normalising constant.

Solution: First, integrate out y_p from the joint density obtained in part (a):

$$f_{Y_1, \dots, Y_{p-1}}(y_1, \dots, y_{p-1}) = \int_0^\infty f_{Y_1, \dots, Y_{p-1}, Y_p}(y_1, \dots, y_{p-1}, y_p) dy_p.$$

The y_p -dependent part is

$$\int_0^\infty y_p^{\sum \alpha_i - 1} e^{-y_p} dy_p = \Gamma\left(\sum_{i=1}^p \alpha_i\right).$$

Thus

$$f_{Y_1, \dots, Y_{p-1}}(y_1, \dots, y_{p-1}) = \frac{\Gamma(\sum_{i=1}^p \alpha_i)}{\prod_{i=1}^p \Gamma(\alpha_i)} \left(\prod_{i=1}^{p-1} y_i^{\alpha_i-1} \right) \left(1 - \sum_{i=1}^{p-1} y_i \right)^{\alpha_p-1},$$

which is the Dirichlet density with parameters $(\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_p)$.

Next, to find the marginal distribution of Y_p , integrate out $y_1, \dots, y_{p-1}$ from the joint density:

$$f_{Y_p}(y_p) = \int_{\mathcal{S}} f_{Y_1, \dots, Y_{p-1}, Y_p}(\dots) dy_1 \dots dy_{p-1},$$

where $\mathcal{S} = \{y_i > 0, \sum_{i=1}^{p-1} y_i < 1\}$. The integral over the simplex of the Dirichlet kernel is

$$\int_{\mathcal{S}} \prod_{i=1}^{p-1} y_i^{\alpha_i-1} (1 - \sum y_i)^{\alpha_p-1} dy_1 \dots dy_{p-1} = \frac{\prod_{i=1}^p \Gamma(\alpha_i)}{\Gamma(\sum_{i=1}^p \alpha_i)}.$$

Therefore,

$$f_{Y_p}(y_p) = \frac{1}{\prod_{i=1}^p \Gamma(\alpha_i)} \cdot \frac{\prod_{i=1}^p \Gamma(\alpha_i)}{\Gamma(\sum \alpha_i)} \cdot y_p^{\sum \alpha_i - 1} e^{-y_p} = \frac{1}{\Gamma(\sum_{i=1}^p \alpha_i)} y_p^{\sum \alpha_i - 1} e^{-y_p}.$$

Hence

$$Y_p \sim \text{Gamma}\left(\sum_{i=1}^p \alpha_i, 1\right).$$

Moreover, the joint density factorises as the product of the Dirichlet density for $(Y_1, \dots, Y_{p-1})$ and the Gamma density for Y_p . Therefore, $(Y_1, \dots, Y_{p-1})$ and Y_p are independent.

Final answers:

- Joint pdf of $(Y_1, \dots, Y_p)$ is as in the boxed expression above.
- $(Y_1, \dots, Y_{p-1})$ has Dirichlet($\alpha_1, \dots, \alpha_p$) distribution.
- Y_p has Gamma($\sum \alpha_i, 1$) distribution, independent of $(Y_1, \dots, Y_{p-1})$.